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EUROPEAN UNION AGENCY
FOR CYBERSECURITY

ENISA Threat Landscape 2026

SEPTEMBER 2026

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CONTACT

To contact the authors, please use etl@enisa.europa.eu
For media enquiries about this paper, please use press@enisa.europa.eu.

AUTHORS

ENISA

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EEAS STRATCOM

Europol

Automotive Information Sharing and Analysis Center (Auto-ISAC)

Aviation Information Sharing and Analysis Centre (Aviation ISAC)

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Executive Summary

The 2025 cyber threat landscape affecting the European Union remained **shaped by a combination of threats, sometimes driven by geopolitical developments**, and the growing interconnectedness of digital ecosystems.

1. **DDoS attacks (51.3%) and unauthorised access (39.5%)** continued to account for a large share of the recorded activity affecting EU Member States and EU-based organisations. **Social engineering** remained a common enabling tactic to abuse trust, particularly through phishing campaigns (77.8%), increasingly supported by phishing kits and service-based ecosystems. The exploitation of **vulnerabilities**, including N-day and 0-day vulnerabilities, also remained a prevalent intrusion vector to enable unauthorised access (60.4%). At the same time, the targeting of supply chains, third-party providers, cloud environments and other **cyber dependencies** continued resulting in impactful and large-scale incidents.

Financially motivated activities (29.3% of all recorded incidents), particularly ransomware, remained the **most impactful incidents in the short-term**. Ransomware, data breaches, phishing and fraud impacted a broad range of sectors, reflecting the continuing adaptability of the cybercrime ecosystem. Manufacturing, business services and public administration were among the sectors most affected by cybercrime-related activities. Across the reporting period, ransomware operators continued relying on extortion and data exposure through public claims shared on Data Leak Sites (DLS) and dark web forums, while fraud and phishing activity highlighted the continued importance of credential compromise, impersonation and social engineering techniques, notably through the increased use of ClickFix and SMS phishing (smishing).

Geopolitical developments such as the continuation of Russia's war of aggression against Ukraine or the conflict escalation in the Middle East **continued influencing cyber activity impacting the EU**. Ideology-driven operations represented a significant share of the observed activity (57.3%), particularly through hacktivist-led DDoS campaigns targeting public-facing services, essential entities and organisations associated with political developments or support for countries such as Ukraine or Israel. State-nexus intrusion sets continued conducting cyberespionage activities (5.9%), with Russia-nexus intrusion sets primarily targeting central governmental and diplomatic entities, and China-nexus intrusion sets showing continuous interest in the transport sector including maritime related entities. A resurgence in State-nexus financially motivated campaigns was observed.

2025 confirmed the **continued exposure of sectors** to cyber threats, including sectors of high criticality according to NIS2. Public administration remained the most impacted sector (31.8%), followed by business services (8.5%), transport (8%), manufacturing (6.9%) and finance / banking (5.6%). Sectoral analysis further highlighted differences in targeting patterns, threat groups and operational impact across sectors, notably showing the criticality of digital dependencies, sensitive data holdings and operational maturity in shaping exposure to cyber threats.

Another notable development throughout the reporting period was the **continued adaptation of threat groups' operational playbooks**. Cybercriminal, hacktivist and State-nexus threat groups increasingly relied on scalable techniques, shared tooling patterns and trusted digital environments to conduct malicious activities. 2025 also observed the continued integration of **artificial intelligence** into malicious cyber activities, including activities carried out by cybercriminal operators, State-nexus intrusion sets and Information Manipulation Sets (IMS).

Looking ahead, ENISA assess that **several of the dynamics observed during 2025 are likely to persist** into the next reporting period. Organisations across the EU will continue facing a combination of cybercrime, cyberespionage and hacktivist activity driven by geopolitical developments. While objectives remain distinct, cybercriminal, hacktivist and State-nexus operators increasingly rely on

similar access vectors, tools and operational approaches, making imputation and threat analysis more challenging. Cybercrime is expected to remain one of the most significant sources of disruption to organisations operating in the EU, supported by mature criminal ecosystems, evolving extortion models and the continued availability of specialised services and tooling. The reporting period also reinforced the importance of digital dependencies, as incidents affecting software suppliers, service providers and cloud environments continued demonstrating the potential for broader downstream impact. **ENISA assess artificial intelligence will highly likely increasingly support malicious operations**, and its use will likely expand beyond the increased speed, scale and adaptability of cyber operations, **it is also likely 2026 will see an increased number of the kill chain's phases being directly enabled by AI**, with possible experimentation of Human-out-of-the loop proof of concepts. The growing availability of frontier AI models and specialised malicious or dual-use tooling has already demonstrated its impact in augmenting the development of malicious capabilities and will likely lower barriers to entry into malicious cyber activities and further support scaling, automation and velocity across cyber operations. It is also likely that the use of these new models will increase EU organisations' exposure to new threats, arising from both accidental and malicious activities.

Methodology

The updated ENISA Cybersecurity Threat Landscape (ENISA CTL) methodology published in September 2026[1] was used to support the drafting of the ENISA Threat Landscape (ETL).

The ENISA Threat Landscape 2026 report is organised as follows. The first chapter provides an overview of the general threat landscape, highlighting specific trends considered relevant. The second chapter provides a sectoral overview of the incidents recorded in ENISA's dataset. The following chapters of this document provide a deep dive into four main areas, cybercrime, State-nexus activities, hacktivism, and Foreign Information Manipulation and Interference (FIMI). Incidents documented in the FIMI chapter were drawn from the European External Action Service's (EEAS) FIMI Threat Landscape 2025. A chapter is dedicated to the analysis of vulnerabilities disclosed during the reporting period, as well as an outlook to conclude this report.

For the ETL 2026 report, ENISA analysts collected and analysed **8 257 incidents**, mainly based on information from open sources, as well as anonymised information shared by EU Member States (EU MSs) and members of the ENISA Cyber Partnership Programme[2]. **The reporting period of the ETL has been updated to the calendar year**, i.e. the analysis takes into consideration incidents recorded from 1 January 2025 to 31 December 2025; hence, this report presents an overlap of six months with the previous ETL, presenting trends already described in the ETL2025.

For this ETL, ENISA also **expanded the number of tracked cybercrime activities** (including data breaches and fraud). While this was observed to have an impact on the numbers presented in this report, it did not substantially change the trends and rankings observed in the previous iteration. Of note, data breaches, frauds, scams and ransomware are expected to present overlaps (i.e. data exfiltrated through fraud schemes and ransomware deployments are advertised in forums, and data advertised in those forums are subsequently used in fraud schemes and ransomware deployments).

As much as possible, primary sources are referenced in footnotes to substantiate ENISA's assessments. ENISA appreciates that open sources and information shared voluntarily do not constitute a complete picture of the cyber threat landscape. Moreover, multiple caveats are inherent to open-source reporting. Those notably include **reporting granularity and temporality**. For instance, vague sectoral or geographic reporting (e.g. 'private companies', 'Europe') is likely to impact ENISA's dataset and analysis. Another caveat concerns proper sectoral categorisation, especially when one incident impacts an organisation operating in multiple sectors. To avoid inflating the threat, ENISA analysts undertook a thorough curation of the dataset either by choosing one specific sector or by registering the incident as 'unknown'. While particular attention was paid to the matter, it is highly likely a deviation will remain. Another example is the reporting of a specific number of targeted or impacted EU organisations in one report, whereas other reports will just mention the targeting of an EU MS. This notably affects the ranking of sectors and State-nexus intrusion sets. It should be noted that incidents are not necessarily reported immediately or confirmed in open sources. For instance, while ransomware and DDoS are more immediate 'visible' threats often claimed directly by their operators, cyberespionage campaigns are typically documented with a delay often spanning

[1] https://www.enisa.europa.eu/publications/enisa-cybersecurity-threat-landscape-methodology
[2] https://www.enisa.europa.eu/topics/cyber-threats/situational-awareness/enisa-cyber-partnership-programme-cpp

from six months to more than four years. It should also be noted that, to some extent, increased reporting of a specific threat does not necessarily reflect an increased tempo of activity but rather speaks to the audience's interest, particularly linked to a specific geopolitical context. Furthermore, while the number of hacktivist claims remain high, the threat of cyberespionage represents a more impactful threat in the long term.

Hence, **this report should be seen as an overview of prevailing trends**, constituting a snapshot of threats faced by EU MSs and EU-based organisations.

To differentiate between what was reported by other sources and ENISA's own assessments, words of estimative probability are used, described within a matrix available in the Appendix.

1. Overview & Trends

Based on the analysis of the ENISA dataset, **DDoS remain the primary incident type (51.3%)**, followed by unauthorised access (39.5%). Among social engineering techniques, **phishing remains a prevalent intrusion vector** (77.8%), followed by malicious spam (malspam), accounting for 13%.

An **increasing use of the ClickFix technique**, abusing victim into 'fixing' an issue, ultimately leading to the execution of malicious code[3] [4], was prevalent in 2025. ENISA also observed the popularisation of phishing kits and Phishing-as-a-Service (**PhaaS**) platforms to further enable financially motivated cyber activities (see cybercrime threats chapter)[5] [6].

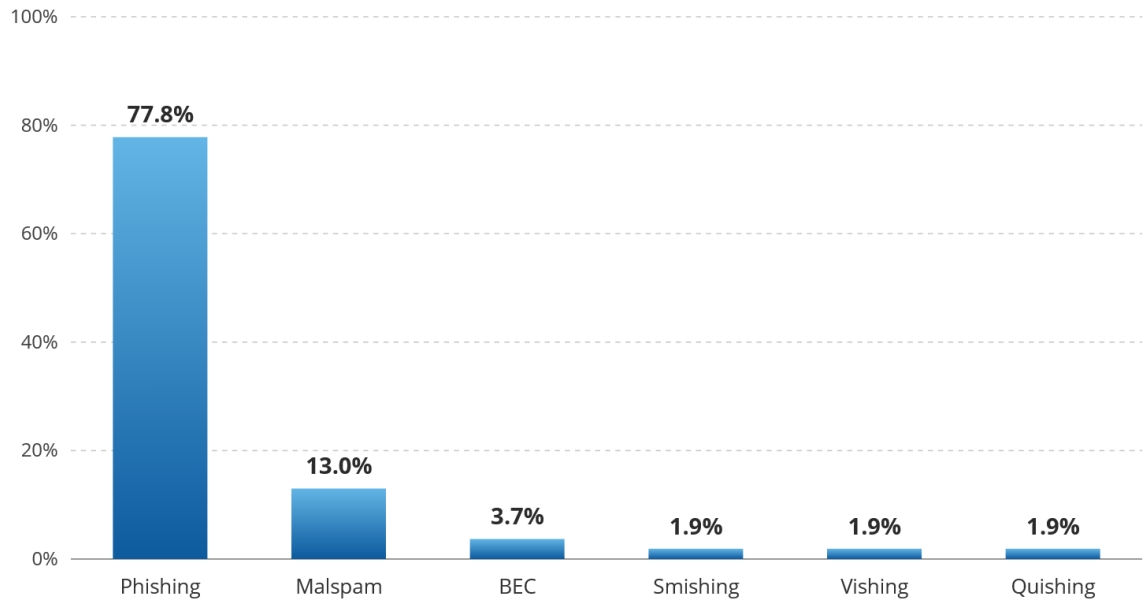


Figure 1 - Social engineering techniques leveraged in identified incidents targeting the EU

Exploitation of N-day and 0-day vulnerabilities remains a prevalent intrusion vector. Across incidents of unauthorised access for which ENISA was able to identify an intrusion vector (5.2%), 60.4% were seen leveraging a vulnerability, while **misconfiguration and accidental exposure** remain a concern (20.7%). Unauthorised access by **insider threats contributed an increased share** compared to the previous ETL, likely due to the threat posed by Famous Chollima, an intrusion set associated to the Democratic People's Republic of Korea (DPRK)

[3] https://news.sophos.com/en-us/2025/12/18/i-am-not-a-robot-clickfix-used-to-deploy-stealc-and-qilin/
[4] https://www.proofpoint.com/us/blog/threat-insight/around-world-90-days-state-sponsored-actors-try-clickfix
[5] https://catalyst.prodaft.com/public/report/lucid/overview
[6] https://www.trellix.com/blogs/research/phaas-phishing-as-a-service-on-the-rise/

seeking employment as IT workers globally, including in EU companies, notably defence and government-related entities[7] [8] [9] (see State-nexus threats chapter).

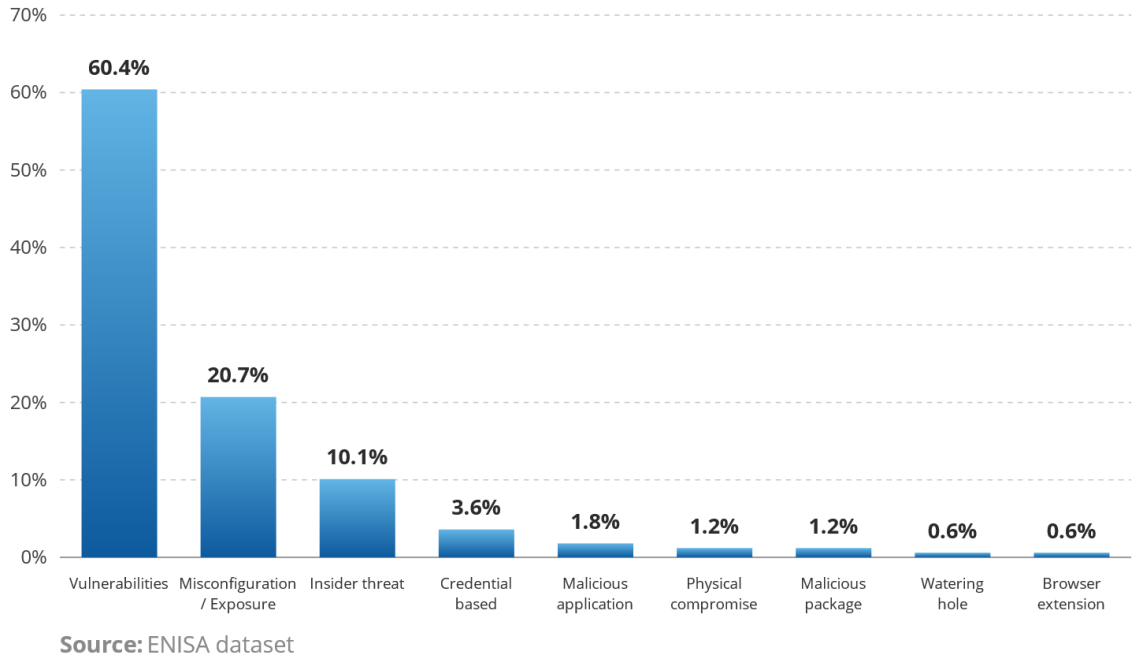


Figure 2 - Intrusion vectors observed in unauthorised access incidents in the EU

The **targeting of cyber dependencies**, including **supply-chain attacks and third-party attacks** continued to be observed, with several examples of large-scale and/or impactful incidents throughout the reporting period. Cybercriminals increasingly targeted third-party providers, such as digital services, highly likely as an opportunity to optimise the efficiency of their attacks[10] [11] [12] [13] [14].

Adversaries were also seen exploiting the digital supply chain, notably by compromising software, repositories or browser extensions[15] [16] [17] [18](see sectoral analysis, cybercrime and State-nexus chapters). Of particular concern was the increase in compromises of popular libraries or npm packages, as seen with the Shai-Hulud campaign[19] [20]. In March 2026, ENISA published a technical advisory for the secure use of package managers[21].

The distribution of incident types remains **dominated by low-impact DDoS attacks**, which make up 51.3% of all recorded incidents, primarily shaped by geopolitical developments and political

[7] https://cloud.google.com/blog/topics/threat-intelligence/dprk-it-workers-expanding-scope-scale
[8] https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/resources/reports/threat-hunting-report/
[9] https://go.crowdstrike.com/2026-global-threat-report.html
[10] https://news.sophos.com/en-us/2025/05/27/dragonforce-actors-target-simplehelp-vulnerabilities-to-attack-msp-customers/
[11] https://www.tribunatreviso.it/cronaca/mon-hacker-attacco-biglietti-xueo4que
[12] https://www.fsbusitalia.it/it/umbria/news-umbria/2025/4/9/comunicazione-di-una-violazione-dei-dati-personali-agli-interess.html
[13] https://www.bvg.de/de/unternehmen/medienportal/pressemitteilungen/2025-05-15-statment-it-angriff-dienstleister
[14] https://www.acn.gov.it/portale/documents/20119/923891/operational_summary_apr2025_CLEAR_EN.pdf
[15] https://socket.dev/blog/60-malicious-npm-packages-leak-network-and-host-data
[16] https://socket.dev/blog/north-korean-apt-lazarus-targets-developers-with-malicious-npm-package
[17] https://socket.dev/blog/lazarus-strikes-npm-again-with-a-new-wave-of-malicious-packages
[18] https://www.koi.ai/blog/4-million-browsers-infected-inside-shadypanda-7-year-malware-campaign
[19] https://www.trendmicro.com/en_gb/research/25/i/npm-supply-chain-attack.html
[20] https://www.trendmicro.com/en_gb/research/25/k/shai-hulud-2-0-targets-cloud-and-developer-systems.html
[21] https://www.enisa.europa.eu/sites/default/files/2026-03/ENISA%20Technical%20Advisory%20-%20Package_Managers_Final.pdf

statements. The second half of 2025 recorded an increased number of intrusion claims by hacktivist groups, notably pertaining to the targeting of **Operational Technology (OT)** (see hacktivist threats chapter). Unauthorised access follow with 39.5%, dominated by financially motivated activities (63.9%), followed by ideology driven claims (15.3%), and cyberespionage (13.6%).

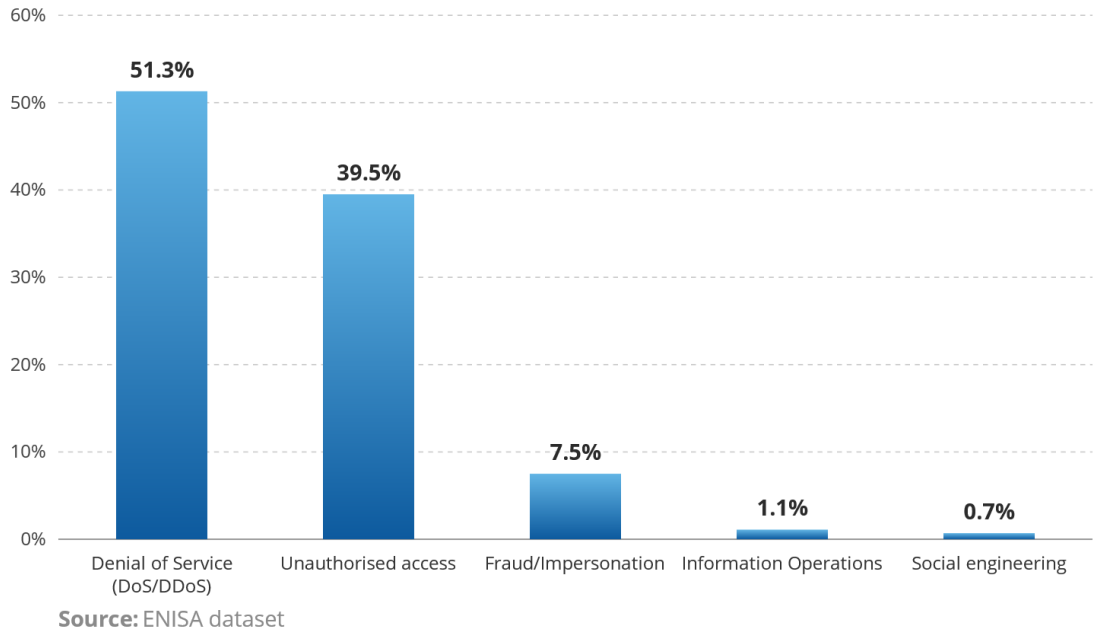


Figure 3 - Breakdown of incident types impacting the EU

Based on assessed objectives, **cyber activities targeting or impacting the EU mostly pertained to ideology-driven incidents** (57.3%), followed by financially motivated operations (29.2%). Cyberespionage campaigns accounted for 6.3%. As mentioned, despite representing most incidents, ideology-driven claims did not result in large-scale or significant impact. Though accounting for lower numbers, **financially motivated activities remain the most impactful threat to EU organisations in the short-term** and cyberespionage represents a significant strategic threat in the mid to longer-term. This is also reflected in ENISA's NIS investments report[22], where DDoS are characterised as 'noise' by representatives of EU organisations operating in NIS sectors of high criticality, while ransomware dominate organisational concerns.

[22] https://www.enisa.europa.eu/publications/nis-investments-2025

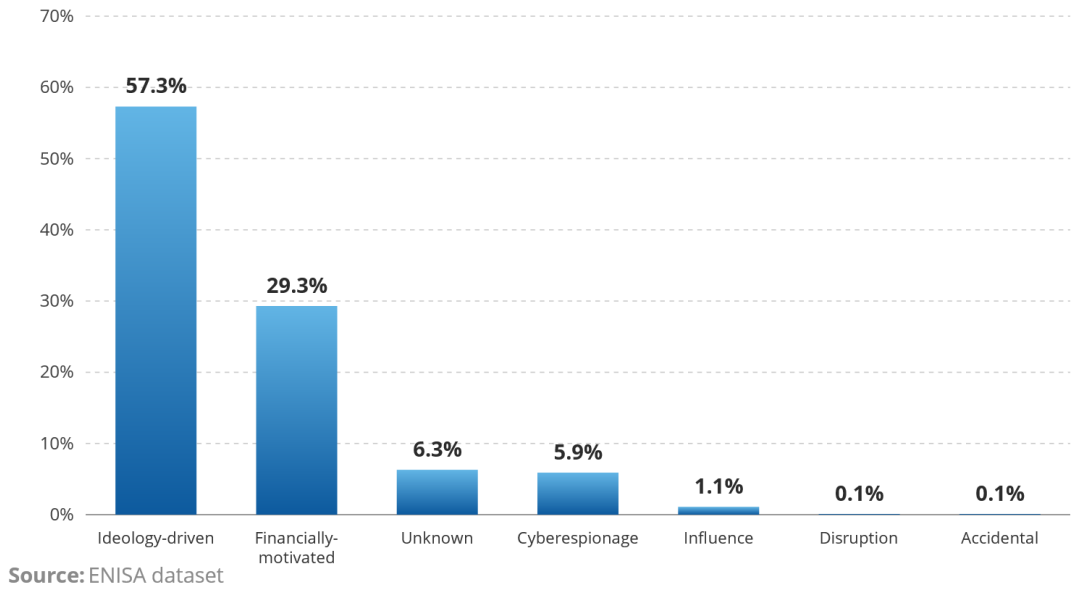
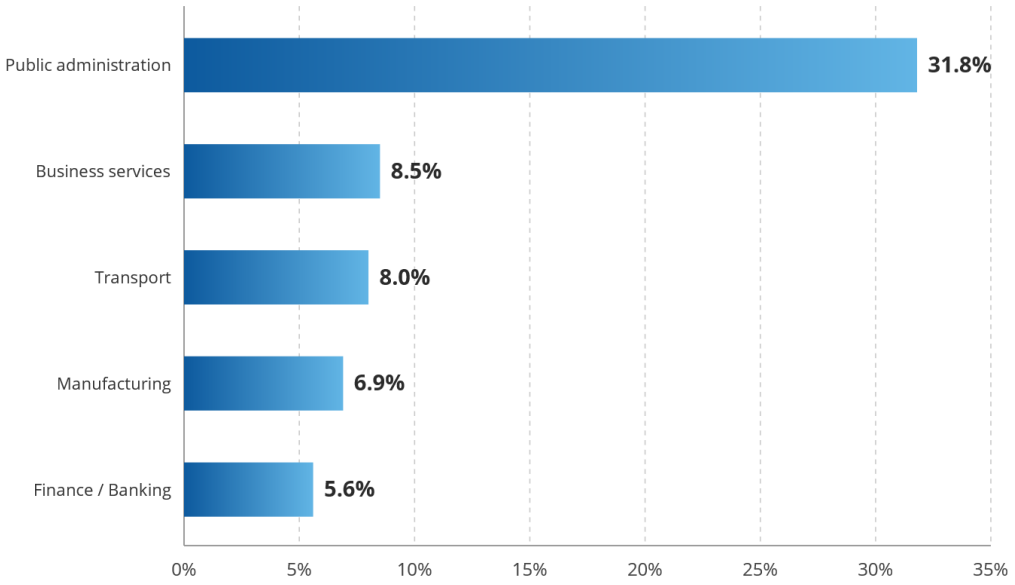


Figure 4 - Breakdown of incidents by assessed objectives

As already flagged in ETL 2025, the **distinction between threat categories continued to blur**. Similar techniques, infrastructures and access mechanisms appeared repeatedly across cybercrime, hacktivist and State-nexus reporting, despite differences in underlying objectives. This was notably exemplified by hacktivist-led DDoS waves by pro-Russia groups around electoral events and geopolitical developments, where increased activity was often observed as typical FIMI-aligned behaviour to associate disruption with aspects of information operations (see hacktivist threats chapter). Another illustration is the **leveraging of cybercrime tradecraft or toolsets** such as ransomware and infostealers **by State-nexus intrusion sets**, as seen with Moonstone Sleet's use of the Qilin ransomware [23] [24] [25] (see State-nexus threats chapter).

The **top five targeted sectors** in the EU include public administration (31.8%), business services (8.5%), transport (8%), manufacturing (6.9%) and finance/ banking (5.6%), with essential entities representing 72.9% of the total number of recorded incidents. As in the previous ETL report, public administration remains the most targeted sector, with the threat picture **largely impacted by ideology-driven DDoS attacks** (see sectoral and hacktivism chapters).

[23] https://x.com/MsftSecIntel/status/1897738961348374621
[24] https://go.cyberproof.com/hubfs/CyberProof_MidYear_Cyber%20Threat%20Landscape%20Report.pdf
[25] https://services.google.com/fh/files/misc/m-trends-2025-en.pdf



Source: ENISA dataset

Figure 5 - Top 5 impacted / targeted sectors in the EU

ENISA continued to observe an increasing use of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** by malicious cyber threat groups, including cybercriminals, State-nexus and Information Manipulation Sets (IMS), primarily to facilitate or enhance their activities to optimise the speed and success rates of their operations overall. The integration of AI systems into enterprise environments creates a new attack surface. Threat groups, including State-nexus intrusion sets, IMS and cybercriminals demonstrate consistent interest in AI systems both as tools to facilitate malicious activity and as targets for exploitation[26] [27] [28] [29] [30] [31] [32] [33]. Despite this activity, reporting over 2025 indicates that attackers primarily use consumer-grade AI tools to augment existing skills and adapt attack vectors rather than to achieve breakthrough capabilities.

While attackers primarily use AI to augment existing skills, model improvements have already been seen accelerating vulnerability discovery and exploitation. In 2025, Frontier AI labs continued to assess that threat groups are primarily leveraging closed AI models to augment existing skills rather than achieve novel breakthrough capabilities[34] [35]. Prior efforts spanned basic applications such as the use of LLMs to craft and distribute tailored phishing messages at scale, develop text and media for deployment in influence campaigns and generate synthetic identities for remote-worker schemes[36] [37] [38]. Threat groups continue to experiment with methods for bypassing closed model

[26] https://www.group-ib.com/blog/the-dark-side-of-automation-and-rise-of-ai-agent/
[27] https://www.sentinelone.com/labs/akirabot-ai-powered-bot-bypasses-captchas-spams-websites-at-scale/
[28] https://www.trendmicro.com/en_us/research/25/c/ai-assisted-fake-github-repositories.html
[29] https://www.phonely.ai/blogs/how-does-ai-voice-cloning-work
[30] https://www.europol.europa.eu/cms/sites/default/files/documents/vishing_final_version.pdf
[31] https://www.security.com/threat-intelligence/malware-ai-llm
[32] https://research.checkpoint.com/2025/funksec-alleged-top-ransomware-group-powered-by-ai/
[33] https://www.sentinelone.com/blog/blackmamba-chatgpt-polymorphic-malware-a-case-of-scareware-or-a-wake-up-call-for-cyber-security/
[34] https://cdn.openai.com/threat-intelligence-reports/7d662b68-952f-4dfd-a2f2-fe55b041cc4a/disrupting-malicious-uses-of-ai-october-2025.pdf
[35] https://cloud.google.com/blog/topics/threat-intelligence/threat-actor-usage-of-ai-tools
[36] https://www.ic3.gov/PSA/2026/PSA260521
[37] https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cx2r7grrdwzo
[38] https://www.silentpush.com/blog/unmasking-the-dprk-remote-worker-problem/

safeguards and constraints, including steganography and indirect prompt injection[39] [40] [41] [42]. 2025 also saw the development of more industrialised methods for ensuring reliable, affordable and anonymised access to premium LLM tiers. The reporting period saw further proliferation of likely AI-generated malware leveraged in real-world operational contexts, as seen with an LLM-produced sample reportedly exploiting the React2Shell vulnerability[43]. AI was also used to conduct reconnaissance, script development and post-exploitation, often supported by 'turnkey' AI-assisted toolkits resold via underground marketplaces[44] [45] [46].

Another relevant trend to highlight throughout the reporting period includes the **increased abuse of messaging applications and the leveraging of device code phishing** by multiple intrusion sets[47] [48] [49] [50] [51] [52] [53]. 2025 saw large scale campaigns targeting multiple EU MSs and sectors leveraging trusted communications platforms such as Signal or WhatsApp to initiate personalised contact and steering targets toward authentication through legitimate workflows to gain full access to compromised devices[54].

[39] https://cloud.google.com/blog/topics/threat-intelligence/ai-vulnerability-exploitation-initial-access
[40] https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/security/blog/2026/03/12/detecting-analyzing-prompt-abuse-in-ai-tools/
[41] https://www.miggo.io/post/weaponizing-calendar-invites-a-semantic-attack-on-google-gemini
[42] https://labs.zenity.io/p/agentflayer-chatgpt-connectors-0click-attack-5b41?
[43] https://www.darktrace.com/blog/ai-llm-generated-malware-used-to-exploit-react2shell
[44] https://www.sophos.com/en-us/blog/pointing-a-cursor-at-evading-detection
[45] https://www.sysdig.com/blog/ai-agent-at-the-wheel-how-an-attacker-used-llms-to-move-from-a-cve-to-an-internal-database-in-4-pivots
[46] https://www.sophos.com/en-us/blog/ai-in-the-underground-curiosity-claims-and-concerns
[47] https://www.volexity.com/blog/2025/02/13/multiple-russian-threat-actors-targeting-microsoft-device-code-authentication/
[48] https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/security/blog/2025/02/13/storm-2372-conducts-device-code-phishing-campaign/
[49] https://www.volexity.com/blog/2025/04/22/phishing-for-codes-russian-threat-actors-target-microsoft-365-oauth-workflows/
[50] https://blog.sekoia.io/apt28-operation-phantom-net-voxel/
[51] https://cloud.google.com/blog/topics/threat-intelligence/russia-targeting-signal-messenger/
[52] https://cloud.google.com/blog/topics/threat-intelligence/adversarial-misuse-generative-ai
[53] https://cloud.google.com/blog/topics/threat-intelligence/ai-vulnerability-exploitation-initial-access
[54] https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/security/blog/2025/01/16/new-star-blizzard-spear-phishing-campaign-targets-whatsapp-accounts/

AI THREAT

While outside the reporting period, ENISA cannot overlook the evolution and emergence of advanced AI models in 2026, which have already shaped the threat landscape, notably through Proof of Concept (PoC) research related to AI-powered malware, and the first signs of malware using generative AI at runtime[55]. The most established trend remains the **use of AI to support and accelerate existing techniques** leveraged by malicious operators. Microsoft reported the operationalisation of AI by threat groups across different stages of cyber activity[56], while Anthropic reported that a state-nexus group used an agentic AI system during a campaign against unidentified international targets, with a limited number of successful compromises[57].

AI continued to be reported for phishing, fraud and malware development, including through impersonation of legitimate AI services. A fake Claude AI website, for example, was used to distribute malware[58], while cybercriminal forums continued discussing generative AI for phishing, fraud and malware development[59]. Analysis of the Gentlemen ransomware group, particularly active in the EU, also documented how their operators used AI coding assistants to develop the group's Ransomware-As-A-Service (RaaS) panel[60]. Of particular interest is the potential for AI to **increase the speed and scale of cyber malicious operations**. An AI-assisted cloud intrusion reportedly achieved administrative access within 8 minutes[61]. AI-assisted discovery and living-off-the-land activity has also been reported[62]. This reinforces concerns around faster PoC development, scanning and **vulnerability exploitation**. Reporting also shows AI becoming **more directly integrated into attack workflows**, as illustrated with the "AI in the Middle" technique, demonstrating how web-based AI services could potentially be abused to ensure **stealthy** operations **and resilience** of adversary infrastructure[63]. AI-linked developer environments and **software supply chains** are another area of concern[64] [65]. **AI applications and their ecosystems are increasingly becoming targets**, particularly where they have access to files, credentials, browser sessions or development environments[66] [67] [68] [69], and AI services may also provide a path into trusted environments[70] [71].

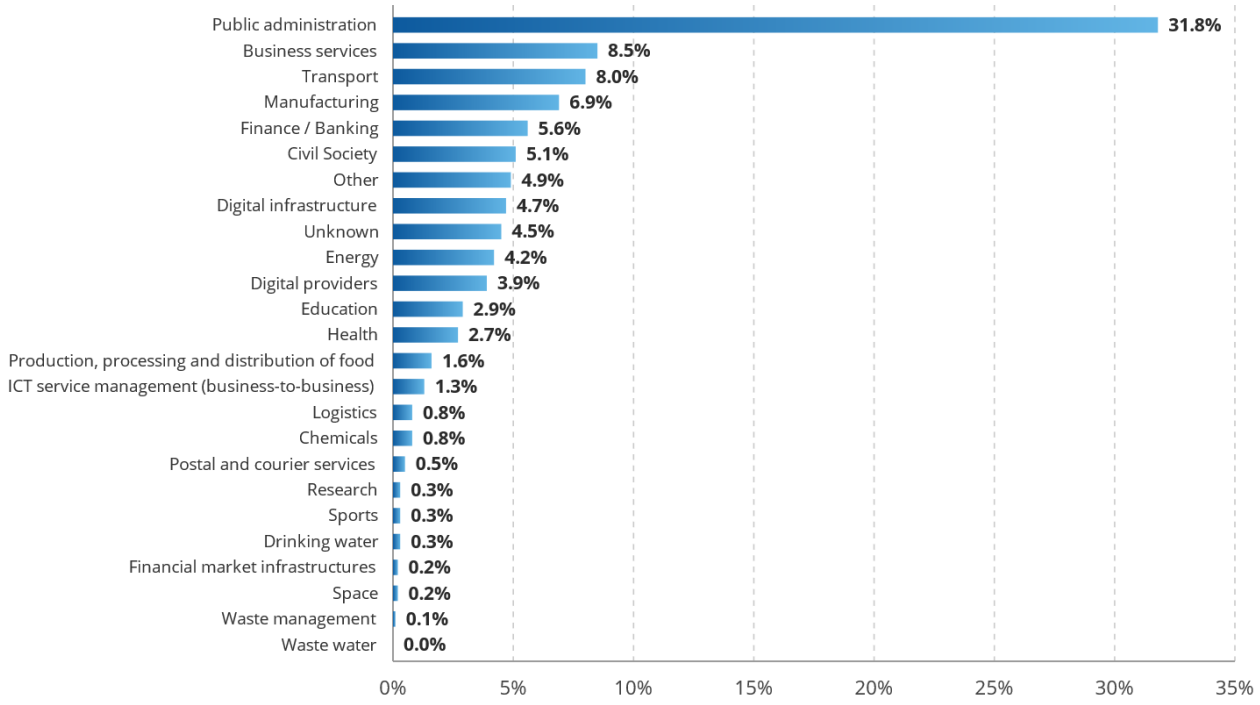
In this context, the European Commission published their EU Action Plan on Cybersecurity and Artificial Intelligence[72], building on the AI Act, the Cyber Resilience Act, NIS 2 and the Cyber Solidarity Act, to address cybersecurity risks and opportunities linked to Artificial Intelligence. On the same day, ENISA published their view on cybersecurity in the Frontier AI Era to provide a set of recommendations when developing operational capabilities[73].

[55] https://www.welivesecurity.com/en/eset-research/promptspy-ushers-in-era-android-threats-using-genai/
[56] https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/security/blog/2026/03/06/ai-as-tradecraft-how-threat-actors-operationalize-ai/
[57] https://www.anthropic.com/news/disrupting-AI-espionage
[58] https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/scams/2026/04/fake-claude-site-installs-malware-that-gives-attackers-access-to-your-computer
[59] https://www.sophos.com/en-us/blog/ai-in-the-underground-curiosity-claims-and-concerns
[60] https://socradar.io/blog/gentlemen-ransomware-leak/
[61] https://www.sysdig.com/blog/ai-assisted-cloud-intrusion-achieves-admin-access-in-8-minutes
[62] https://cloud.google.com/security/report/resources/cloud-threat-horizons-report-h1-2026
[63] https://research.checkpoint.com/2026/ai-in-the-middle-turning-web-based-ai-services-into-c2-proxies-the-future-of-ai-driven-attacks/
[64] https://fieldeffect.com/blog/field-effect-detects-amos-stealer-delivered-via-cursor-ai-agent-session
[65] https://expel.com/blog/inside-lazarus-how-north-korea-uses-ai-to-industrialize-attacks-on-developers/
[66] https://www.greynoise.io/blog/threat-actors-actively-targeting-llms
[67] https://www.pillar.security/blog/operation-bizarre-bazaar-first-attributed-llmjacking-campaign-with-commercial-marketplace-monetization
[68] https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/security/blog/2026/03/05/malicious-ai-assistant-extensions-harvest-llm-chat-histories/
[69] https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/microsoft/microsoft-says-bug-causes-copilot-to-summarize-confidential-emails/
[70] https://vercel.com/kb/bulletin/vercel-april-2026-security-incident
[71] https://www.infostealers.com/article/breaking-vercel-breach-linked-to-infostealer-infection-at-context-ai/
[72] https://ec.europa.eu/commission/presscorner/detail/en/ip_26_1544
[73] https://www.enisa.europa.eu/publications/enisas-view-on-cybersecurity-in-the-frontier-ai-era

2. Sectoral Analysis

This chapter provides a sectoral analysis of incidents identified by ENISA, looking at how cyber activity has impacted sectors covered by the NIS2 Directive[74], as well as additional categories needed to capture relevant activity outside the strict scope of NIS2. Where relevant it is compared with other reports, including reporting by EU MSs under the NIS2 Directive as well as ENISA's NIS360 report, to identify targeting patterns and assessments[75].

The top five targeted sectors in the EU include **public administration (31.8%), business services (8.5%), transport (8%), manufacturing (6.9%) and finance/ banking (5.6%).** While recorded events include non-NIS2 sectors, **essential and important entities represent 73% of the total number of recorded events,** confirming the relevance of the NIS2 approach[76]. In this context, ENISA published their NIS2 technical implementation guidance to ultimately support a common cyber defence posture across the EU for concerned entities[77].



Source: ENISA dataset

Figure 6 - Distribution of identified incidents in the EU per sector

[74] https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/HTML/?uri=CELEX:02022L2555-20221227
[75] https://www.enisa.europa.eu/sites/default/files/2026-05/ENISA%20NIS360%202026.pdf
[76] https://ciras.enisa.europa.eu/
[77] https://www.enisa.europa.eu/sites/default/files/2025-06/ENISA_Technical_implementation_guidance_on_cybersecurity_risk_management_measures_version_1.0.pdf

To complement the open-source-based reporting, figure 7 presents the sectoral distribution of events reported by EU MSs under NIS2 for 2025[78] [79] [80]. Based on the latter, the top five affected sectors include public administration, health, digital infrastructure, banking and transport. Overall, **malicious actions accounted for the largest share of reported root causes across the most impacted sectors**. Public administration appeared as the most affected sector in both cases, while transport and banking/finance were also present among the top five. However, health and digital infrastructure appeared among the top five sectors in Member State reporting. These discrepancies notably stem from different scopes, thresholds and reporting conditions.

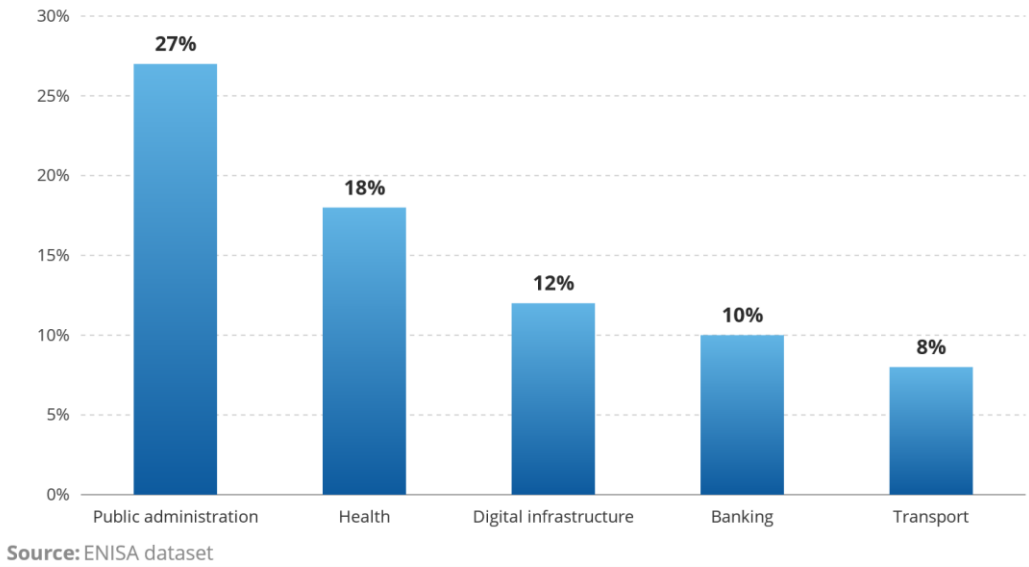


Figure 7 - Events reported by EU MS for 2025 under NIS2, per sector

[78] NIS2 requires EU MS to report notifications concerning incidents, cyber threats and near misses on a voluntary basis by essential and important entities, as well as other entities regardless of whether they fall in scope of NIS2. The term event is used for information reported by EU MS under NIS2 to refer to significant incidents, incidents, cyber threats and near misses.
[79] In 2025 and as to the 14th of July 2026, a total of 1 954 events were reported under NIS2. "Malicious actions" accounted for 941 events, for which around 50% the root cause was reported as unknown.
[80] https://ec.europa.eu/newsroom/dae/redirection/document/132389

2.1 Public administration

As in the previous ETL, public administration remains the **most targeted sector, accounting for 31.8%** of all recorded events. The distribution of incidents affecting public administration over the reporting period shows that **events primarily impacted central** (35.1%) and **local entities** (33.8%). Regional level entities accounted for 10.1% of events. Based on the ENISA NIS360 report, the EU public administration sector remains in the cyber risk zone, where criticality exceeds observed cybersecurity maturity.

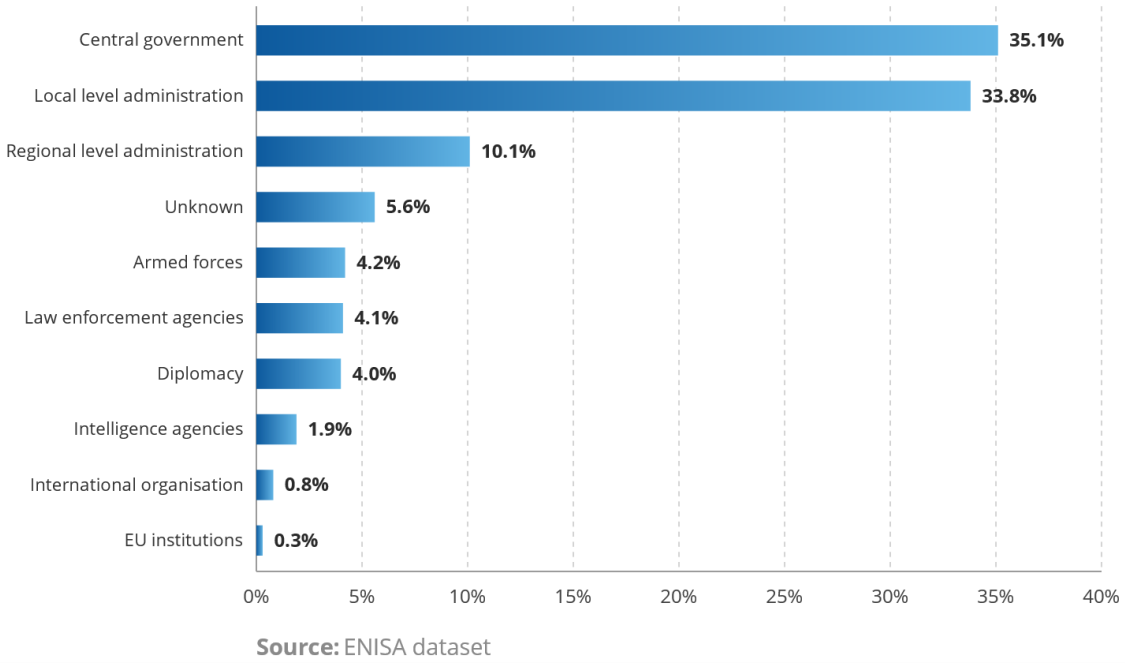


Figure 8 - Incidents impacting the EU public administration sector per sub-sector

The threat picture **is largely impacted by ideology-driven DDoS attacks which accounted for 81.8%** of the recorded incidents (see hacktivist threats chapter). Public-facing websites and portals of public administration entities were **repeatedly targeted around specific events**, such as law-enforcement takedowns and arrests, electoral processes, high visibility events and general geopolitical tensions including Russia's war of aggression against Ukraine and developments linked to the ongoing conflicts in the Middle East[81] [82].

[81] https://www.eurojust.europa.eu/news/hacktivist-group-responsible-cyberattacks-critical-infrastructure-europe-taken-down
[82] https://danish-presidency.consilium.europa.eu/en/news/european-council-adopts-conclusions-to-provide-90-billion-to-ukraine-over-the-next-two-years/